

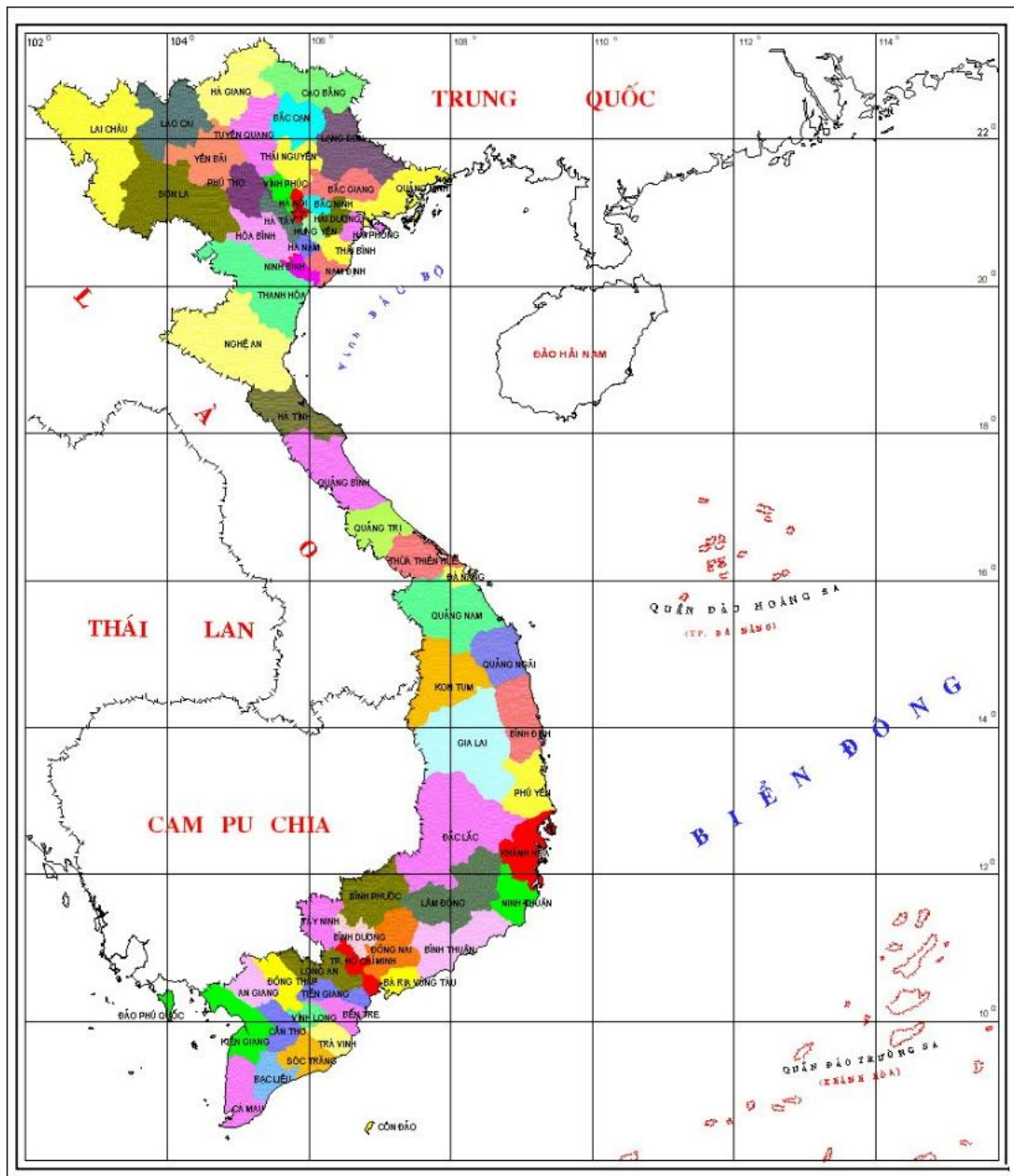
Unit 9

HOME

1. Vocabulary for speaking: Hometown

Location and size (Vị trí và quy mô)

- be located in the northern/central/southern/eastern/western part of Vietnam: nằm ở khu vực phía Bắc/trung tâm/Nam/Đông/Tây của Việt Nam
- It borders to the north, to the south, to the east, to the west: Nó giáp ranh với về phía Bắc, về phía Nam, về phía Đông, về phía Tây.
- a metropolitan area with millions of dwellers: 1 thành phố lớn với hàng trăm triệu dân
- a small town/a coastal city/an ancient city with a population of around: 1 thị trấn nhỏ/1 thành phố ven biển/1 thành phố cổ với số dân vào khoảng



Climate (Khí hậu)

5. **have a tropical/humid subtropical/temperate climate:** có khí hậu nhiệt đới/cận nhiệt đới ẩm/ôn đới
6. **have two distinct seasons - the dry season and the rainy season:** có 2 mùa riêng biệt - mùa khô và mùa mưa
7. **have four distinct seasons: spring, summer, autumn and winter:** có 4 mùa riêng biệt: xuân, hạ, thu, đông
8. **the dry season lasts from ... to ...:** mùa khô kéo dài từ tháng...tới tháng...
9. **It's quite windy/hot/cold/foggy/cloudy,...:** Trời khá nhiều gió/nóng/lạnh/nhiều sương mù/nhiều mây
10. **It's hot and humid with high rainfall:** Trời nóng và ẩm với lượng mưa cao
11. **It's hot and dry with low rainfall:** Trời nóng và khô với lượng mưa thấp

Special features (Những đặc điểm nổi bật)



12. **have spectacular natural landscapes:** có thắng cảnh thiên nhiên tuyệt đẹp



13. **rich natural resources:** tài nguyên thiên nhiên dồi dào



14. **rolling mountains:** các dãy núi trùng trùng



15. **dense forests:** những cánh rừng rậm rạp



16. **historic buildings:** các tòa nhà cổ



17. **stunning ocean views:** cảnh biển tuyệt vời



18. **have well-developed facilities** >< **less-developed facilities (sports facilities, cinemas, shopping malls, ...)**: *có các trang thiết bị phát triển* >< *các trang thiết bị kém phát triển (các cơ sở thể thao, rạp chiếu phim, trung tâm mua sắm,..)*



19. **it's a suitable place for young/old people to live in**: *nó là 1 nơi phù hợp cho người trẻ/già sinh sống*



20. **fantastic public transport system (buses, subway systems...)**: *hệ thống giao thông công cộng tuyệt vời (xe buýt, hệ thống xe điện ngầm...)*



21. **It's historic but modern at the same time**: *nó vừa cổ kính nhưng cũng vừa hiện đại*



22. **get a fantastic view of the city from**: *có được cảnh quang tuyệt đẹp của thành phố từ...*



23. **there are plenty of things to do there**: *có rất nhiều thứ để làm ở đó*



24. **the hustle and bustle of city life**: *sự tấp nập và hối hả của cuộc sống thành phố*



25. **go shopping, go sight-seeing:** *đi mua sắm, đi tham quan*



26. **lively bars and restaurants:** *các nhà hàng và quán bar nhộn nhịp*



27. **famous tourist destinations:** *các điểm đến du lịch nổi tiếng*



28. **attractive green spaces:** *những khu vực xanh đầy hấp dẫn*

Famous tourist attractions in Ho Chi Minh City (*Địa điểm tham quan nổi tiếng ở TP.HCM*)



29. **War Remnants Museum:** *Bảo tàng Chứng tích chiến tranh*



30. **Renunification Palace:** *Dinh Thống Nhất*



31. **Bitexco Financial Tower:** *Tòa nhà tài chính Bitexco*



32. **Notre Dame Cathederal:** *Nhà thờ Đức Bà*



33. **Saigon Central Post Office:** *Bưu điện Sài Gòn*



34. **Cu Chi Tunnels:** *Địa đạo Củ Chi*

Famous tourist attractions in Ha Noi (Địa điểm tham quan nổi tiếng ở Hà Nội)



35. **Hoan Kiem Lake:** Hồ Hoàn Kiếm



36. **Long Bien Bridge:** Cầu Long Biên



37. **Hai Ba Trung Temple:** Đền Thờ Hai Bà Trưng



38. **Temple of Literature:** Văn Miếu Quốc Tử Giám



39. **Ho Chi Minh Mausoleum:** Lăng chủ tịch Hồ Chí Minh



37. **National Museum of Vietnamese History:** Bảo Tàng Lịch sử Quốc gia VN

Urban life and Rural life (Cuộc sống thành thị và nông thôn)

Urban life

38. **much higher living costs:** chi phí sống cao hơn nhiều
40. **higher levels of crime and unemployment:** tỷ lệ tội phạm, thất nghiệp cao hơn
41. **the pace of life is faster:** nhịp điệu cuộc sống nhanh hơn
42. **people often suffer from stress and anxiety due to their busy work schedules:** con người thường bị căng thẳng và lo âu vì lịch trình công việc bận rộn
46. **it's not a suitable place for old people to live in** → due to high levels of noise and pollution: không phải là nơi phù hợp cho người già sinh sống → vì mức độ tiếng ồn và ô nhiễm cao
47. **there are more job opportunities** → attract a large number of young adults from rural areas: có nhiều cơ hội việc làm hơn → thu hút 1 lượng lớn người trẻ từ các vùng nông thôn.

Rural life

39. **lower living costs:** chi phí sống thấp hơn
43. **lower levels of crime, unemployment:** tỷ lệ tội phạm, thất nghiệp thấp hơn
44. **the pace of life is slower:** nhịp điệu cuộc sống chậm hơn
45. **people are more laid back and friendly:** con người thư thả và thân thiện hơn
48. **it's a suitable place for old people to live in** → it's quiet and peaceful: là nơi phù hợp cho người già sinh sống → vì nó yên tĩnh và thanh bình
49. **there are fewer job opportunities** → hardly find a well-paid job → young people tend to move to major cities in search of a better job: có ít cơ hội việc làm hơn → khó mà tìm được 1 công việc lương tốt → người trẻ có xu hướng chuyển lên các thành phố lớn để tìm 1 công việc tốt hơn

2. IELTS Speaking Part 1: Introduction & Interview

	(+) Positive → Like	(-) Negative → Dislike
Facilities	The facilities are well developed, including gyms, schools, hospitals, public transport, and even leisure facilities.	The facilities are less developed, and the resources are a bit limited.
Selection	People have all sorts of choices in my city; they can go shopping, enjoy fantastic delicacies (<i>cao lương mỹ vị</i>), watch films, and so on.	Life in my hometown is a bit monotonous (<i>đơn điệu</i>); people have few entertainment options.
Opportunity	Opportunities in my city are various, from education to job-hunting, from making friends to watching a show, you name it.	Young people can hardly find a well-paid job in my hometown.
Life pace	My hometown is less competitive and stressful than big cities, so people may live a comfy and cosy life in such an environment.	The living cost is a little bit higher than in small places, and people seldom have time to stop and enjoy what they are supposed to.
Environment	My hometown is pretty peaceful and tranquil (<i>thanh bình</i>); it is the perfect place for young people to grow up in.	The air pollution is increasingly serious, and there is traffic congestion everywhere, and I guess young people ought to live in a less crowded place.

1. Could you tell me about your hometown?

- My hometown is which is located in the northern / central / southern part of Vietnam.
- My hometown is which is a metropolis with millions of dwellers. (*thành phố lớn với hàng triệu cư dân*)
- My hometown is which is a medium city with well-developed facilities. (*thành phố quy mô vừa với nhiều tiện ích rất tiên tiến*)
- My hometown is which is a small city with a beautiful natural landscape. (*thành phố nhỏ với cảnh thiên nhiên tươi đẹp*)
- My hometown is which is a collection of villages with rich natural resources. (*khu làng giàu tài nguyên thiên nhiên*)

2. In what ways has your town or city changed since you were a child?

- Actually yes. It has changed enormously. 20 years ago I could barely find tall building around my area, but now I can easily catch sight of skyscrapers and tower blocks there.
- Yes, It has changed enormously. Now there are many new facilities (tall buildings, shopping mall, theatre) are available. Apart from it, people are changing their simple shops into big showrooms.
- Yes it has evolved from a relatively quiet city to a center of shopping and entertainment. There have been major developments, with shopping mall renovations and the addition of shop lined streets leading all around the city. There are also more restaurants and bars catering for all tastes.

3. How could your town or city be improved?

→ I would like to upgrade the infrastructure so that I can avoid being stuck in a traffic jam during peak hours.

→ The city where I live now is beautiful and it's hard for me to think of any way in which it could be improved. I suppose if I had to find something, I'd say that it has mainly chain restaurants and shops, so we could do with a greater range of independent places. It would make eating out and shopping more enjoyable.

→ I think the government should give more financial and healthcare aid to suburban areas of Ho Chi Minh City to reduce the income gap between those areas and the central ones. Greater spending on public transport is also necessary to ease traffic congestion and provide people with an affordable way of travelling around.

4. Are there any traffic problems where you live?

→ Yes, but I think there are traffic problems everywhere in this country, certainly in all the towns and cities. Here, public transport is really expensive, so everyone drives and that means we have standstill traffic during the rush hour. They should increase the affordability of the buses.

→ Yes, of course. I live in one of the largest and busiest metropolitan cities in my country with a huge population, and therefore, it is only expected that we will have traffic congestion primarily because there isn't just enough roads and streets to hold so many vehicles currently. The number of private cars is increasing rapidly while some people do not abide by the traffic rules to make the situation worse.

→ Yes, definitely. With the rapid growth of population, urbanization and transportation, traffic problems in the area, where I live, has become a real cause for concerns because vehicles run at a snail's pace not only during the peak hours but also during the "off-peak" hours sometimes. These traffic problems are not only causing us to lose very valuable 'working hours' but also causing extra fuel consumption and air pollution in Ho Chi Minh City.

5. What do you like most about your hometown?

→ I like the hospitality and the love of people there which I hardly find them in my current place. Everyone is living close together and willing to give others a hand when they need help.

→ I like the city's dynamic lifestyle: young and busy. It attracts me and people from every walks of life thanks to its open atmosphere, a practical attitude, a mix culture, a rapid rhythm....the city never sleeps. This city provides everyone so many opportunities to build up their careers, especially young people who want to build a brilliant social position.

→ To me, the best thing of living in Ho Chi Minh is it is a food paradise. Vietnamese food is some of the tastiest and freshest, and the option for dining out around the city is endless, from hotpot for freezing cold winter days, to Vietnamese bread, a variety of noodles from different regions of the country, all at very reasonable prices. And when I've had enough Viet food, I often order pizzas, Korean food, or whatever I desire for.

6. Is your hometown famous for anything?

→ The biggest feature of of my hometown is

→ The most unique characteristic of my hometown is

→ When it comes to my hometown, will be the first thing that comes into people's mind.

→ There are many time-honoured cultural relics in my hometown such as

- church / pagoda / temple (nhà thờ / chùa / đền)
- historical site (khu di tích lịch sử)
- national park (vườn quốc gia)
- ancient battlefield (chiến trường xưa)

→ My hometown used to be the capital city of dynasty. (*Quê hương tôi từng là kinh đô của triều đại)*

7. Would you prefer to live in another place?

→ Actually, no, I wouldn't. Although my hometown is so polluted, what I would like is to persuade the local government to improve the situation so that people would stay rather than moving to less polluted towns.

→ To be honest, I hope I could come back to my hometown one day to visit my relatives and friends, but to settle down my life there is not my plan. I am getting familiar with city life and there are more job opportunities for my future career.

→ For the moment, I am quite happy living here, but sometimes I really want to live in a place with a lower cost of living and leisurely pace of life. Ho Chi Minh City always makes me get in the rat race which sometimes annoys me because I prefer a sense of community. That is why I usually close down a weekend, and visit some places on the outskirts of the city like Vung Tau.

8. Do you think your hometown is a good place for young people?

→ Definitely yes, my hometown is a perfect place for young people to live in simply because

→ No, I don't think so since my hometown

9. Is there anything you dislike about your hometown?

→ Well, the cost of living is way too high. Whether you want to buy a house or rent a room, the city is very expensive. The closer you are to the center, the more expensive it gets. The cost of living can also be high in other ways. Food, healthcare and transportation are just a few examples.

→ Personally, it's a bit boring for me because as a small town, there isn't a shopping mall or any other means of entertainment. The streets don't get very crowded as well. However, I believe that it is improving day by day and turning into a potential hotspot due to the increasing number of annual visitors.

→ I'd have to say I'm not so keen on the weather. to be precise, I really can't stand the summer months, when the temperatures can get as high as 40 degrees and it is really uncomfortable without air conditioning. In addition, I'm not really that fond of the public transport system. This is because the buses are always so crowded and seats are quite hard, so the journey is usually very uncomfortable!

10. Do you think your hometown is a place worth living?

→ My hometown is both traditional and modern. On the one hand, tradition is preserved by a number of festivals celebrated by local people, and the locals and authorities preserve the historical sites for tourism and education. On the other hand, a whole lot of high-rise buildings as residential places or shopping malls are built, which turns our little hometown into a worth-living place.

3. IELTS Speaking Part 2: Individual long-turn talk

Topic: **Describe a place that you enjoy visiting.**

You should say:

- where the place is
- what you can see and do there
- how it has changed since you first visited it

and explain why you enjoy visiting this place.

Khuôn mẫu trả lời cho dạng “**Describe a place**” cần bao gồm các ý chính sau:

❶ **Introduction:** Chọn 1 mẫu câu dễ nhớ áp dụng chung cho tất cả các đề

- *I'm going to talk about which is one of my must-visit destinations*
- *I'm going to talk about which is my preferred choice to*
- *I'm going to talk about which I would love to*
- *I'm going to talk about which I'm really keen on*

❷ **Body 1:** Nhắc đến một số thông tin cơ bản về địa điểm đó

- **Location and size** (Mô tả về vị trí và quy mô của địa điểm muốn nói đến)
- **How the place look like** (Mô tả về đặc điểm hình dáng bên ngoài của địa điểm đó)
- **How the life is** (Mô tả về cuộc sống nơi đó, về nhịp sống và thái độ của người địa phương)
- **What the place is special for** (Mô tả những đặc điểm nổi bật, điều nổi tiếng của địa điểm)

❸ **Body 2:** Nhắc đến một số gợi ý sau

- **What people/you do there** (Mọi người/ Bạn thường làm gì ở đó)
- **How it has changed since you first visited it** (Nơi đó đã thay đổi như thế nào)
- **Why you enjoy the place / How the place is important** (Lý do vì sao bạn thích địa điểm này)

❹ **Conclusion:** Chọn 1 mẫu câu áp dụng cho tất cả các đề

- *All in all, I wish I can return in this year so that I can enjoy*
- *All in all, I hope I can set aside enough money so that I can pay a visit to soon/again.*

Model answer 1: DA NANG

Introduction:

I'm going to talk about Da Nang which is one of my must-visit destinations before I reach 25.

Body: *Where the place is*

Da Nang is located in Central Vietnam. The landscape in Da Nang is kinda picturesque and tranquil, which everyone chooses to visit when they want to wind down. Local people always show visitors a great sense of hospitality, which explains by the fact that they welcome travellers from walks of life.

Body: *What you can see and do there*

There are ton of things visitors can do when coming there. In the morning, people can do some sightseeing in Son Tra Peninsula and Ba Na Hill in order to take some memorable photos. Afternoon is an ideal time for visitors to go outside to sample Da Nang's specialities. In the evening, travellers can start off the campfire together so that they can play outdoor activities and share stories with each other, which helps strengthen their relationship.

Body: *How it has changed since you first visited it*

To be honest, I haven't visited Da Nang yet, but I have witnessed many remarkable changes in Da Nang over the past 10 years. Many beautiful bridges has been built over the poetic Han River, and the most famous one is the Dragon Bridge which has become the symbol of Da Nang City. In addition, Da Nang is on its way to become an international tourism, service, trade and transportation hub not only in the central region but also of Vietnam.

Body: *Explain why you enjoy visiting this place*

I'm really into Da Nang because of several reasons. Firstly, paying a visit to Da Nang can help me greatly broaden my horizons about the diversity of Vietnamese cuisine. Besides, it will allow me to escape from the hustle and bustle of the hectic life. More importantly, it may be an ideal time for me to strengthen the relationship with my close friends who have been by my side for a long time.

Conclusion:

All in all, I hope I can set aside enough money so that I can pay a visit to Da Nang soon.



Model answer 2: HOI AN

Introduction:

One of the most interesting places I have ever come to was Hoi An ancient town.

Body: *Where the place is*

It is located in Quang Nam, a central region of Vietnam. This place attracts crowds of tourists every year to come and enjoy the wonderful time in Hoi An.

Body: *How it has changed since you first visited it*

I went to Hoi An about 2 years ago when I graduated from high school. At that time, I never thought I could have a wonderful experience in here. Hoi An has really become a holiday destination for everyone who love the breathtaking view and the atmosphere. Every house in Hoi An left me with some memories about the past and also reminded everyone how prosperous the town had.

Body: *What you can see and do there*

I would describe Hoi An in 2 words “graceful and charming”. You know, the whole town is filled with single-storey buildings with beautiful wooden framed, painted mango yellow roofs looking like pagodas. Some notable heritage buildings that attract us are a Japanese-designed bridge, merchant houses and assembly halls several centuries ago.

I visited Hoi An ancient town because I was craving for sampling the local food in here. The cuisine of central region was so different from other regions. We enjoyed some flavourful authentic local specialities in here such as pork pancakes, “Cao Lau” - a pork noodle dish and so on. We even joined great cooking classes to bring home those unique Hoi An flavours.

Body: *Explain why you enjoy visiting this place*

What I absolutely love about Hoi An is how peaceful it is. You know, you can enjoy a wander around because vehicles are not allowed during day time. So you can feel the slow pace of life in all its beautiful corners. Also, the Riverside is the best place to be at night as the entire area is lit by old-fashioned lanterns, making it an charming spot. The weather was also a factor which made me love this place much. I believed the cool weather of Hoi An would get rid off the heat of summer in southern area.

Conclusion:

I really enjoyed my time in Hoi An ancient town. It was a one-of-a-kind experience, and if I have enough money, I will gladly have another trip back to this town.



4. IELTS Speaking Part 3: Discussion

HOME (Note: Questions in this sub-topic will appear in the final exam)

1. What are the differences between living in a city and living in the countryside?

Urban life

- **much higher living costs:** *chi phí sống cao hơn nhiều*
- **higher levels of crime and unemployment:** *tỷ lệ tội phạm, thất nghiệp cao hơn*
- **the pace of life is faster:** *nhịp điệu cuộc sống nhanh hơn*
- **people often suffer from stress and anxiety due to their busy work schedules:** *con người thường bị căng thẳng và lo âu vì lịch trình công việc bận rộn*
- **it's not a suitable place for old people to live in** → due to high levels of noise and pollution: *không phải là nơi phù hợp cho người già sinh sống* → vì mức độ tiếng ồn và ô nhiễm cao
- **there are more job opportunities** → attract a large number of young adults from rural areas: *có nhiều cơ hội việc làm hơn* → *thu hút 1 lượng lớn người trẻ từ các vùng nông thôn.*

Rural life

- **lower living costs:** *chi phí sống thấp hơn*
- **lower levels of crime, unemployment:** *tỷ lệ tội phạm, thất nghiệp thấp hơn*
- **the pace of life is slower:** *nhịp điệu cuộc sống chậm hơn*
- **people are more laid back and friendly:** *con người thư thả và thân thiện hơn*
- **it's a suitable place for old people to live in** → it's quiet and peaceful: *là nơi phù hợp cho người già sinh sống* → vì nó yên tĩnh và thanh bình
- **there are fewer job opportunities** → hardly find a well-paid job → young people tend to move to major cities in search of a better job: *có ít cơ hội việc làm hơn* → *khó mà tìm được 1 công việc lương tốt* → *người trẻ có xu hướng chuyển lên các thành phố lớn để tìm 1 công việc tốt hơn*

2. Do you think it's better for children to grow up in the city or the country?

→ For several reasons I think that it is better for children to grow up in the country that offers numerous advantages. First of all, it is very important for a child to grow up in a healthy environment. Children need fresh air, not polluted by the huge amount of cars and factories of the modern city. In the country, they can spend more time exercising and walking with their friends. Another important aspect of this is that parents will have more time to spend with their children as a result of eliminating traffic jams and decreasing driving time as a whole.

→ Personally, children have some advantages living in a big city. First of all, a big city usually has many entertaining centres with movie theatres and play stations. When I was a child I liked to go to the movie theatre with my parents to watch a premiere. One more reason to choose a big city for a child is that a city provides better live conditions and services such as medical, dental, etc. My friend lived in the country for a while and one time he and his family had to drive a couple of hours to the nearest medical centre when his child got a heavy cough.

3. Why do some people retire to the countryside?

→ I suppose they want the peace and quiet after a lifetime of hard work in the hustle and bustle of the city. In fact, in the modern imagination, I think the city is associated with work and the country with relaxation. Of course, people like farmers do work in the countryside, so it's not an completely accurate picture, but nevertheless it is how the two opposing settings are often regarded.

→ There are several health and financial benefits when retiring to rural areas. As regards advantages to our health, retired people have a chance to enjoy the fresh and pollution-free air in the countryside rather than suffer from a long-term exposure to severely-polluted air in big cities, which helps us avoid respiratory diseases and other health problems. About financial ones, the cost of living in rural areas tend to be much lower than that in urban areas, so people don't financially struggle when it comes to their daily expenses as compared to city dwellers.

HOMESICKNESS & PATRIOTISM (Note: Just read for your reference, not in exam)

4. Is it only children who experience homesickness?

Further reading:

https://www.countryschools.co.uk/uploads/Homesickness-advice_HZKcYUzR.pdf



Homesickness: advice for parents

Homesickness is a form of anxiety caused by being away from the routines and familiar environment of home and family. Most people suffer from homesickness at some point in their lives – at school, at university, even on business trips. The feelings of sadness and distress can vary in severity and may manifest themselves in different ways.

For most children, their first (and second and third and fourth...) visit to English Country Schools will be an enjoyable and rewarding experience. They will improve their English, have fun, make new friends, develop new skills and increase their self-confidence.

Some children will however experience homesickness and this is normal. It's not easy to predict which children will suffer. In general younger children are more likely to be homesick and overcome it quickest. Older children are less likely to be homesick but sometimes find it harder to overcome it. You may be surprised to find that your child adjusts to life at English Country Schools without a problem – or surprised to find that he or she does not.

A child who overcomes homesickness becomes stronger. For a very few children (about one in two hundred) there comes a point at which, having tried everything, it is best to remove the child from the school. This should be considered a last resort. Homesickness is not covered by our insurance so there will be no refund of fees. The child's personal happiness is of course more important than money and removal from the school if necessary should not be considered a failure. But remember that the child's long-term happiness is best served by learning to overcome problems and not giving in too easily.

We will do everything we can to help your child to settle in at the school, providing warm, friendly adult support and activities to help your child to mix and make new friends. Shortly after arrival we will give all children a tour of the school to help to familiarize them with their new environment. We will make sure your child understands the timetable, routines and procedures. If your child is homesick we will provide appropriate support to help your child to overcome his or her problem.

→ Children probably feel homesickness more acutely because they may never have been away from home before and because they are still closely attached to their parents. They cannot appreciate the cultural insights of a new place, or the time off work, the way an adult can. And they are generally less flexible when it comes to coping with unfamiliar food and so on. However, many adults also experience culture shock when they visit a new place, which I suppose can be considered a kind of 'adult homesickness'. We find a place strange and even slightly disturbing, and this is because it is different to what we are used to. So, in a sense, we miss our familiar surroundings and are indeed homesick.

5. Are people from your country patriotic?

→ On the whole, I would say yes they are. I think most people in the world are patriotic. You can see this at the SEA Games or AFF Cup where thousands of people go to support their countries' sportspeople and millions if not billions more watch from the comfort of their own homes, cheering their countrymen on and willing them to win. It's a very powerful force, patriotism, and has been responsible for much good and bad. But I think the SEA Games or AFF Cup shows us the best and most inclusive side of patriotism.

→ Yes, I do believe that Vietnamese people are patriotic because our country has given us so much in order to make us the persons that we are today. After all, the act of patriotism paves the way for a stronger nation by uniting all the citizens together with a common goal in mind to achieve. Besides, Patriotism would allow us to take pride in our countries' past, present and future achievements and thus become better placed to stand and rise against the difference and the enemies that try to weaken our country.

6. Why do people often feel proud of where they come from?

→ People feel the need to belong, to a club, to a family, to a group of friends, to a region, and to a country. Where you come from is tied up with so many other things that it says an awful lot about you, and so is of the utmost importance in defining who you are. For example, it affects what you eat, what language you speak, and how you behave towards others. Being proud of where you are from is therefore an extension of being proud of who you are.

→ People feel proud of their country because that could be their birthplace or their country could be famous for certain cuisines or scenic spots. Specifically, there are a lot of reasons why I feel proud to be a Vietnamese. Vietnamese food is the best because all taste amazing while being incredibly healthy and cheap. In addition, Vietnam has many picturesque places. Take Ho Chi Minh City for example, while it is supposed to adopt a crazy busy hectic urban life style, you can still find quiet and beautiful places in some corners of this city, like Tao Dan Park, PNC Book Café, etc.

7. Does intense patriotism have any disadvantages?

Further reading: <https://prosancons.com/government/pros-and-cons-of-patriotism/>

Cons of (intense) Patriotism:

1. ***Creates division***: Patriotism divides more people than it actually gathers. People who support different ideologist end up discriminated and some people may think certain lives are more important than others.
2. ***Affects the growth of nations***: To have a better world, patriotism should be practiced with limitation by avoiding things which might threaten anti-patriotism or create some grievances between nations.
3. ***Costly affair***: To love, respect and support the countries traditions, it requires an individual to abide by the country's laws and act responsibly by paying taxes.
4. ***Create enmity***: When patriotism turns political, it can turn groups against the other and it can lead to the enmity of fundamental values. Supporting the countries policies blindly may lead to wars between nations.
5. ***Unquestionable loyalty***: There are occasional problems associated with blind loyalty to an entity. Support for your countries policies may lead people to sacrifice themselves for the nation and do things without thinking.
6. ***Privacy invasion***: Patriotism requires people to abide by government rules and sometimes the rules may infringe their privacy where the government collects personal information without their knowledge. This jeopardizes personal freedom.
7. ***Anti-immigrants***: During World War II, immigrants were suspected of terrorist activities and were detained without being given a chance to prove their innocence. This creates a traumatic experience to them and also those who want to visit the country as immigrants

→ Oh, undoubtedly. The flipside of patriotism is xenophobia (*sự bài ngoại*), people disliking others who are from another country and associating all kinds of negative characteristics with them. People are capable of believing that everyone from 'that country over there' is mean, rude, dirty et cetera. It's quite frightening, really, because it could be argued that xenophobia has made it easier for governments to justify going to war with other nations over the centuries.